

'About Us' sections may give you the answers you seek before you waste the site owner's time by e-mailing for information that is readily available on their site.

If a Web site owner takes the time to provide information, read it. No one person's time is more important than another's, and common courtesy includes respecting this fact. If you do not find what you are looking for, search for the appropriate contact area for your question. Don't just click on the first e-mail link you come across and blurt out your question(s). If you do, don't be surprised if your e-mail goes unanswered if the information is easily found on the site.

It is important to understand the focus of each Web site as well. Each site cannot be everything to everyone, or be what you perceive it should be. Be sure to review the information provided to double-check that what you seek would even be covered by the site you are visiting.

8. Do not use Return Receipt Request (RR) for each and every personal e-mail you send because you like 'knowing' when someone opens your e-mail. Not only is this annoying to the recipient, this feature is intrusive! How would you like it if every time you heard a voice mail, answering machine message, or opened a postal letter from a friend, it was immediately reported back to them that you had heard/opened their communications? The recipient should have the privacy to determine when/if they want to open, read and reply—period. RRs should be reserved for those instances where it is critical to

Tip

Don't fall for flammers, jerks or "trolls".

"Trolling" is the practice of sending or posting obviously offensive comments, brutally untruthful statements or words and phrases that we all know to be those that would instigate a fight if stated at your local pub!